

Public Administration - Chapter One Quiz

Complete answer key with explanations

Source: Chapter One lecture slides (Dr. Ayah Rabie). Every answer is based on the lecture; no external sources were needed. The correct option is highlighted in green, followed by the reason and the lecture slide it comes from.

Section A: True or False

1. Public administration can be adequately defined by relying exclusively on the managerial perspective because public administration is primarily concerned with the executive function of government.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture says no single perspective is enough; PA must be defined by taking all perspectives into consideration.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 7): "We can't rely on one perspective only to reach for better definition of PA. It should be defined while taking into consideration all the different perspectives."

2. From the political perspective, public administration includes activities undertaken for the public interest.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: Working for the public interest is part of the political perspective.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 3): "It is working for public interest."

3. The political perspective views public administration as doing collectively what individuals cannot accomplish individually.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: This is stated word for word under the political perspective.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 3): "It is doing collectively what can't be done individually."

4. From the legal perspective, public administration is described as "law in action."

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: "Law in action" is the legal perspective's description.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 4): "It is law in action."

5. According to the legal perspective presented in the chapter, government should interfere extensively in the private lives of citizens.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture says the opposite: from the legal perspective, government should not interfere in citizens' lives.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 4): *"From a legal perspective, the government should not interfere in the life of the citizens."*

6. The managerial perspective identifies public administration as the executive function of government.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: This is the managerial perspective's definition.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 5): *"It is the executive function of the government."*

7. The occupational perspective considers public administration to be whatever the public employee does.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: This is the occupational perspective's definition.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 6): *"It is whatever the public employee does."*

8. Public administration as an academic field applies both the art and science of management to the public sector.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: The occupational perspective also describes PA as an academic field applying both art and science of management.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 6): *"It is an academic field of applying both the art and the science of management in the public sector."*

9. The chapter argues that one perspective alone is sufficient for reaching a better definition of public administration.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture says one perspective alone cannot be relied on.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 7): *"We can't rely on one perspective only to reach for better definition of PA."*

10. The comprehensive perspective defines public administration in terms of governmental activities aimed at serving communities, achieving common good, and providing goods and services.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: This matches the comprehensive definition.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 8): *"All the activities undertaken by the governments to serve their communities by working for common good and creating positive change through the provision of goods and services."*

11. Public administration involves decisions concerning the use of public resources for maximum public good.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: The comprehensive perspective states this directly.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 9): *"Public Administration involves taking decisions that affect the use of public resources for maximum public good."*

12. Public administration professionals operate only at the federal level because local and state governments do not constitute levels of public administration.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture lists local, state and federal levels.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 9): *"Public administration professionals manage at: All governmental levels (local, state, and federal)."*

13. Relationships between different levels of government within one country can represent a growing public administration problem.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: The lecture names this as a growing problem of public administration.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 10): *"The relationships between different levels of government within a single country represent a growing problem of public administration."*

14. Public administration exists only in countries that follow a particular system of government.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture says it exists in all countries regardless of their system of government.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 10): *"Public administration is a feature of all countries, regardless of their system of government."*

15. Civil servants and professional scientific civil servants both work for the government.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: The lecture states that both groups work for the government.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 11): *"Civil servants and professional civil servants work for the government."*

16. A civil servant, as defined in the chapter, performs a political, military, or constabulary role.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The definition says the civil servant's role is NOT political, military, or constabulary.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 12): *"A civil servant is directly employed in the administration of the internal affairs of the country and whose role is not political, military, or constabulary."*

17. Professional scientific civil servants provide technical support rather than general administrative support.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: This is how the lecture describes them.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 13): *"They are the parties that provide technical support rather than general administrative support."*

18. Police, justice, and military personnel are given in the chapter as examples of professional scientific civil servants.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: The lecture gives these as the examples.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 13): *"Ex: police, justice, military."*

19. Protecting citizens' lives and properties is one of the public purposes of government.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: It is the first public purpose listed.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 14): *"Protecting the lives and the properties of the citizens."*

20. The supply of essential products and services is excluded from the public purposes of government because these activities belong exclusively to the private sector.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture lists the supply of essential products and services as a public purpose of government. It never says these activities belong exclusively to the private sector.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 14): *"Insuring the supply of all the essential products and services (food /water/ energy /medical care)."*

21. The purposes of government are independent of one another and generally do not reinforce each other.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture says the purposes overlap and reinforce each other.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 16): *"The purposes of the government overlap and reinforce each other."*

22. Planning seeks to reduce uncertainty faced by decision makers by considering the future and possible choices.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: Planning reduces uncertainty by assessing the future, and planners identify the available choices and their possible outcomes.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 18 and 20): "Planning is used to reduce the uncertainty faced by the decision maker by: Assessing the future. ... planners can: 1) identify the choices available for the decision maker..."

23. Planning requires the future to be assessed with complete accuracy before decisions can be made.

True

False (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture says the future cannot be assessed with 100% accuracy, yet planners can still identify choices and outcomes.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 20): "Although the future can't be assessed with 100% accuracy, planners can: 1) identify the choices available for the decision maker and 2) identify the possible outcomes are associated with each choice."

24. Coordination includes securing cooperation and teamwork and dealing with conflicts, overlapping situations, and working at cross-purposes.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: Both parts appear in the lecture's definition of coordination.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 22): "Securing co-operation and team work among several employees working in the organization. Removing conflicts and working at cross purposes and overlapping situation."

25. Budget allocation can be used as a mechanism for carrying out the controlling function in public administration.

True (CORRECT ANSWER)

False

Why: Allocation of funds is named as one way of controlling.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 25): "Allocation of funds is one way of controlling public administration."

Section B: Multiple Choice

26. Which statement most accurately reflects the chapter's reason for using multiple perspectives when defining public administration?

A. Public administration has no stable meaning.

B. Each perspective reveals a different dimension of public administration. (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. The managerial perspective is incorrect.

D. The political perspective completely replaces the other perspectives.

Why: The lecture presents several perspectives and says PA must be defined by considering all of them, not one alone. Option B is the closest match. The lecture does not use the phrase "different dimension" itself, but A, C and D all contradict Slide 7.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 2 and 7): "...definitions can be handled from several perspectives... It should be defined while taking into consideration all the different perspectives."

27. A government activity is justified primarily because it addresses something that individuals cannot accomplish independently. Which perspective is most directly reflected?

A. Legal

B. Occupational

C. Political (CORRECT ANSWER)

D. Managerial

Why: This idea belongs to the political perspective.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 3): "It is doing collectively what can't be done individually."

28. The expression "law in action" is associated with which perspective?

A. Political

B. Legal (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. Managerial

D. Occupational

Why: "Law in action" is the legal perspective.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 4): "It is law in action."

29. Which of the following is NOT one of the perspectives used in the chapter to discuss public administration?

A. Political

B. Legal

C. Managerial

D. Financial (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: The lecture's four perspectives are political, legal, managerial and occupational. Financial is not among them.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 2): "Political / Legal / Managerial / Occupational"

30. A researcher defines public administration as the executive function of government. This definition most directly reflects the:

- A. Political perspective
- B. Legal perspective
- C. Managerial perspective (CORRECT ANSWER)**
- D. Occupational perspective

Why: The executive function of government is the managerial perspective.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 5): *"It is the executive function of the government."*

31. Which statement best represents the occupational perspective?

- A. Public administration is law in action.
- B. Public administration is what the government does.
- C. Public administration is whatever the public employee does. (CORRECT ANSWER)**
- D. Public administration is the allocation of public resources.

Why: A is the legal perspective and B is the political perspective. C is the occupational perspective.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 6): *"It is whatever the public employee does."*

32. Which conclusion is most consistent with the comprehensive perspective?

- A. Public administration is limited to government employees.
- B. Public administration concerns only administrative procedures.
- C. Public administration encompasses governmental activities serving communities and pursuing common good. (CORRECT ANSWER)**
- D. Public administration is exclusively concerned with enforcing laws.

Why: The comprehensive perspective defines PA as all governmental activities that serve communities and work for the common good.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 8): *"All the activities undertaken by the governments to serve their communities by working for common good..."*

33. Which of the following best illustrates public administration's concern with public resources?

- A. A private consumer choosing between two brands
- B. A government department deciding how to allocate its available funds (CORRECT ANSWER)**
- C. An individual selecting a university course
- D. A private firm changing its packaging

Why: Public administration involves decisions on the use of public resources, and the lecture says each branch receives funds to carry out its activities. The other options are private choices.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 9 and 25): *"...decisions that affect the use of public resources for maximum public good. / Every branch of public administration receives certain amount of funds to carry out its activities."*

34. According to the chapter, public administration professionals manage at:

- A. Only the federal level
- B. Only the local level
- C. Local, state, and federal levels (CORRECT ANSWER)**
- D. Only the state level

Why: The lecture says all governmental levels.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 9): *"All governmental levels (local, state, and federal)"*

35. Which issue is specifically identified as a growing problem of public administration?

A. Competition between private companies

B. Relationships between different levels of government within one country (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. Differences between consumer preferences

D. International tourism

Why: The lecture names relationships between levels of government within a single country as a growing problem.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 10): *"The relationships between different levels of government within a single country represent a growing problem of public administration."*

36. Which statement is consistent with the chapter?

A. Public administration is found only in democratic systems.

B. Public administration is a feature of all countries regardless of their system of government. (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. Public administration exists only in federal countries.

D. Public administration exists only where civil servants are politically appointed.

Why: The lecture says it is a feature of all countries regardless of system of government.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 10): *"Public administration is a feature of all countries, regardless of their system of government."*

37. Which characteristic distinguishes a civil servant according to the chapter?

A. The person must perform a military function.

B. The person must perform a political function.

C. The person's role is directly connected with internal affairs and is not political, military, or constabulary. (CORRECT ANSWER)

D. The person must provide technical support exclusively.

Why: The definition ties the civil servant to the internal affairs of the country in a role that is not political, military or constabulary. Technical support describes the professional (scientific) civil servant.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 12): *"A civil servant is directly employed in the administration of the internal affairs of the country and whose role is not political, military, or constabulary."*

38. Which of the following is identified as an example of professional scientific civil servants?

A. Marketing managers

B. Retail employees

C. Police personnel (CORRECT ANSWER)

D. Private consultants

Why: Police is one of the lecture's examples.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 13): *"Ex: police, justice, military."*

39. Professional scientific civil servants are primarily associated with:

A. Technical support (CORRECT ANSWER)

- B. Political campaigning
- C. Private-sector management
- D. Consumer research

Why: They provide technical support rather than general administrative support.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 13): *"They are the parties that provide technical support rather than general administrative support."*

40. Which of the following is NOT listed as a public purpose of government?

- A. Environmental protection
- B. Protecting lives and properties
- C. Promoting scientific and technological advancement

D. Maximizing private corporate profits (CORRECT ANSWER)

Why: A, B and C are among the seven public purposes. Maximizing private corporate profits is not listed.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 14-15): *"Protecting the lives and the properties... Environmental protection... Promoting scientific and technological advancement."*

41. Ensuring the availability of food, water, energy, and medical care represents which government purpose?

- A. Environmental protection

B. Supplying essential products and services (CORRECT ANSWER)

- C. Scientific advancement
- D. Maintaining governmental hierarchy

Why: These examples are listed under insuring the supply of essential products and services.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 14): *"Insuring the supply of all the essential products and services (food /water/ energy /medical care)."*

42. Government support for people who cannot care for themselves primarily reflects:

- A. Protection of private property

B. Provision of support for vulnerable individuals (CORRECT ANSWER)

- C. Promotion of technological advancement
- D. Administrative coordination

Why: The lecture lists providing support for those who cannot care for themselves as a public purpose.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 14): *"Providing support for those who can't care for themselves or have others to care for them."*

43. Which combination contains only public purposes identified in the chapter?

A. Environmental protection, balanced economic growth, quality of life (CORRECT ANSWER)

- B. Corporate profitability, advertising, market share
- C. Political campaigning, private investment, consumer loyalty
- D. Brand development, exports, private consumption

Why: All three in option A are listed as public purposes. The other options contain items that are not.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 15): *"The promotion of balanced economic growth. Environmental protection. Maintaining the quality of life."*

44. The chapter states that the different purposes of government:

- A. Conflict with each other in most circumstances
- B. Are unrelated to each other

C. Overlap and reinforce each other (CORRECT ANSWER)

- D. Apply only to local governments

Why: This is stated in the lecture's note.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 16): *"The purposes of the government overlap and reinforce each other."*

45. Which public administration function is primarily concerned with assessing the future and setting goals?

- A. Organizing

B. Planning (CORRECT ANSWER)

- C. Coordinating
- D. Controlling

Why: Assessing the future and setting goals are the lecture's description of planning.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 18): *"Assessing the future. Participating in setting future goals. Setting goals for plan achievement."*

46. One major purpose of planning is to:

- A. Eliminate all uncertainty

B. Reduce the uncertainty faced by decision makers (CORRECT ANSWER)

- C. Prevent organizational change
- D. Replace decision makers

Why: The lecture says planning reduces uncertainty. It does not claim to eliminate it (Slide 20).

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 18): *"Planning is used to reduce the uncertainty faced by the decision maker..."*

47. Why has the importance of planning increased in public administration according to the chapter?

- A. Because governments no longer need budgets

B. Because of rapid technological changes (CORRECT ANSWER)

- C. Because coordination is no longer necessary
- D. Because public organizations have stopped changing

Why: The lecture gives rapid technological changes as the reason.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 19): *"The importance of planning in the domain of public administration has increased due to the rapid technological changes."*

48. Which statement correctly reflects the chapter's treatment of forecasting the future?

- A. The future can be assessed with 100% accuracy.
- B. The future cannot be assessed at all.

C. Although the future cannot be assessed with complete accuracy, planners can identify available choices and possible outcomes. (CORRECT ANSWER)

- D. Planning requires no consideration of possible outcomes.

Why: Option C restates Slide 20 almost exactly.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 20): *"Although the future can't be assessed with 100% accuracy, planners can: 1) identify the choices available for the decision maker and 2) identify the possible outcomes are associated with each choice."*

49. A public organization redesigns its internal components to facilitate achievement of organizational goals. Which function is being performed?

- A. Planning

B. Organizing (CORRECT ANSWER)

- C. Coordinating
- D. Controlling

Why: Designing and arranging the components of the internal environment to attain goals is the lecture's definition of organizing.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 21): *"...design, and arrange the components of internal environment of the public organization to facilitate attainment of the organizational goals."*

50. Which activity most clearly represents coordination?

- A. Establishing future organizational goals
- B. Designing the internal structure

C. Securing cooperation and teamwork among employees (CORRECT ANSWER)

- D. Preparing the annual budget

Why: A is planning, B is organizing and D relates to controlling through funds. Securing cooperation and teamwork is coordination.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 22): *"Securing co-operation and team work among several employees working in the organization."*

51. A department experiences overlapping responsibilities and employees working at cross-purposes. Which function most directly addresses this situation?

- A. Planning
- B. Organizing

C. Coordinating (CORRECT ANSWER)

- D. Forecasting

Why: Removing conflicts, cross-purposes and overlapping situations is part of coordination.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 22): *"Removing conflicts and working at cross purposes and overlapping situation."*

52. According to the chapter, the purpose of control is to:

A. Eliminate public organizations

B. Remove obstacles (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. Replace planning

D. Increase uncertainty

Why: The lecture states this directly.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 23): *"The purpose of control is to remove the obstacles."*

53. Which statement best reflects the controlling function?

A. It concerns only employee recruitment.

B. It enables the public organization to interact with its environment and situations arising within it. (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. It is limited to setting future objectives.

D. It focuses exclusively on teamwork.

Why: The lecture says controlling enables the organization to interact with its environment and with situations arising within it.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 24): *"Controlling enables the public organization to interact with the environment around it or the situation that arises within it."*

54. Which of the following is specifically identified as a way of carrying out the controlling function?

A. Allocation of funds (CORRECT ANSWER)

B. Advertising

C. Market segmentation

D. Product differentiation

Why: Allocation of funds is the way the lecture names.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 25): *"Allocation of funds is one way of controlling public administration."*

55. A public administration branch is required to prepare a budget explaining how requested funds will be spent. This primarily illustrates:

A. Planning only

B. Organizing only

C. Controlling through allocation of funds (CORRECT ANSWER)

D. Coordination through teamwork

Why: The lecture uses the budget requirement as its example of controlling through allocation of funds.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 25): *"Every public administration branch is asked to prepare a budget and show how the required funds will be spend..."*

56. A government agency examines future conditions, identifies alternative courses of action, and considers the possible outcomes associated with each alternative. Which combination of ideas from the chapter is MOST directly represented?

A. Organizing and coordination

B. Planning and uncertainty reduction (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. Controlling and budget allocation

D. Occupational and legal perspectives

Why: Assessing the future and identifying choices and their outcomes is planning, whose aim is to reduce uncertainty.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 18 and 20): "...identify the choices available for the decision maker and... the possible outcomes are associated with each choice."

57. A public organization discovers that two departments are performing similar activities while neither department is communicating effectively with the other. Which function is most directly required to address the problem described?

A. Planning

B. Organizing

C. Coordinating (CORRECT ANSWER)

D. Controlling

Why: Similar activities without communication is an overlapping situation, which coordination removes.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 22): "Removing conflicts and working at cross purposes and overlapping situation."

58. A government department receives a specified amount of funds at the beginning of the financial year and must later submit a report describing its achievements. This situation most directly demonstrates:

A. The controlling function (CORRECT ANSWER)

B. The political perspective

C. The occupational perspective

D. The supply of essential services

Why: Receiving funds and reporting achievements at year end is the lecture's example of controlling.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slide 25): "Every branch... receives certain amount of funds... At the end of the financial year, every department is bounded to submit reports which contain its achievement."

59. Which scenario best combines the comprehensive perspective with the public purposes of government?

A. A private company increasing its profit by reducing wages

B. A government agency providing essential services while pursuing community welfare and positive change (CORRECT ANSWER)

C. An individual purchasing a private product

D. A company developing a commercial advertising campaign

Why: Option B joins the comprehensive definition (serving communities and creating positive change) with the purpose of supplying essential services.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 8 and 14): "...to serve their communities by working for common good and creating positive change... / Insuring the supply of all the essential products and services."

60. A student argues: "Public administration means only what government employees do, so there is no need to consider government purposes, public resources, or different levels of government." Which response is most consistent with the chapter?

A. The argument is fully correct.

B. The occupational perspective alone provides a complete definition.

C. Public administration should be understood through multiple perspectives and comprehensively. (CORRECT ANSWER)

D. Public administration is exclusively a legal concept.

Why: The student relies only on the occupational perspective, which the lecture says is not enough. The comprehensive view also covers purposes, public resources and levels of government.

Lecture reference (Ch.1, Slides 7-9): *"We can't rely on one perspective only... It should be defined while taking into consideration all the different perspectives."*

Quick Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	F	16	F	31	C	46	B
2	T	17	T	32	C	47	B
3	T	18	T	33	B	48	C
4	T	19	T	34	C	49	B
5	F	20	F	35	B	50	C
6	T	21	F	36	B	51	C
7	T	22	T	37	C	52	B
8	T	23	F	38	C	53	B
9	F	24	T	39	A	54	A
10	T	25	T	40	D	55	C
11	T	26	B	41	B	56	B
12	F	27	C	42	B	57	C
13	T	28	B	43	A	58	A
14	F	29	D	44	C	59	B
15	T	30	C	45	B	60	C